Field notes

The committee reviewed the quarterly figures and found that the growth in the northern region was driven mostly by two large contracts signed late in the period.

Costs rose more slowly than revenue, which improved the operating margin for the third quarter in a row, although the finance team warned that energy prices remain volatile.

Several smaller offices were merged during the year, and the savings from those mergers are expected to appear in the accounts over the next eighteen months.

Customer satisfaction scores stayed flat, and the survey showed that delivery times are still the most common complaint among long-standing customers.

The board asked for a detailed plan to reduce the backlog of open orders before the end of the financial year, with monthly progress reports to the audit group.

Investment in the new warehouse system continued on schedule, and the first two sites went live without any significant disruption to daily operations.